

and personalising the driving experience of the driver," predicts Pai.

Further integration of connectivity features like Wi-Fi, DLNA and MirrorLink will enable users to have access to content on the move. According to Panduranga, however, connected car is the new trend with a lot of possibilities, but the industry needs some more time to evaluate its true benefits.

With increasing fuel costs and pollution levels, sustainable growth of the automotive industry depends on the use of alternative fuels and energy sources like fuel cells, solar power and electric power. Introduction of green technologies in the form of hybrid and electric vehicles would strongly increase the use of sophisticated electronic controls to achieve maximum efficiency and reliability.

"Electrification of cars using hybrid engines is one potential for exploration in India. For the short-term, full electric cars might not be suitable considering the electrical grid infrastructure and charging facilities required. However, hybrid engines enable the highest efficiency possible in specific usage environment, in addition to cutting back the pollution in cities," says Kumar.

While commenting on futuristic technologies, Ramachandra mentioned the need for complete control of the infotainment system as well as importance of collision-detection systems through car-to-car information exchange without any human intervention.

Make in India, on the way

According to Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY), majority of investment proposals received by the department in the last one year for Make in India campaign are from the automotive electronics sector.

"As the industry requires coordination of logistics, basic infrastructure such as roads, networks, electric grid supply and support of all essential suppliers, these require effective government policies to support such growth," says Kumar.

While commenting on the possibility of increasing automotive electronics manufacturing in India, Panduranga opines, "With favourable investment policies and a large pool of talent, India does have a good chance of becoming a manufacturing hub."

He adds, "There are many schemes announced for the electronics manufacturing sector, which should encourage more investors to make in India. Both central and state governments encourage investments in the electronic system design and manufacturing (ESDM) sector. We are also one of the beneficiaries of modified special incentive package scheme (M-SIPS) scheme. It is moving in the right direction and I am sure more investments will happen in India. Special mention should be made about M-SIPS, where the entire process is handled in a transparent and professional way." ●


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